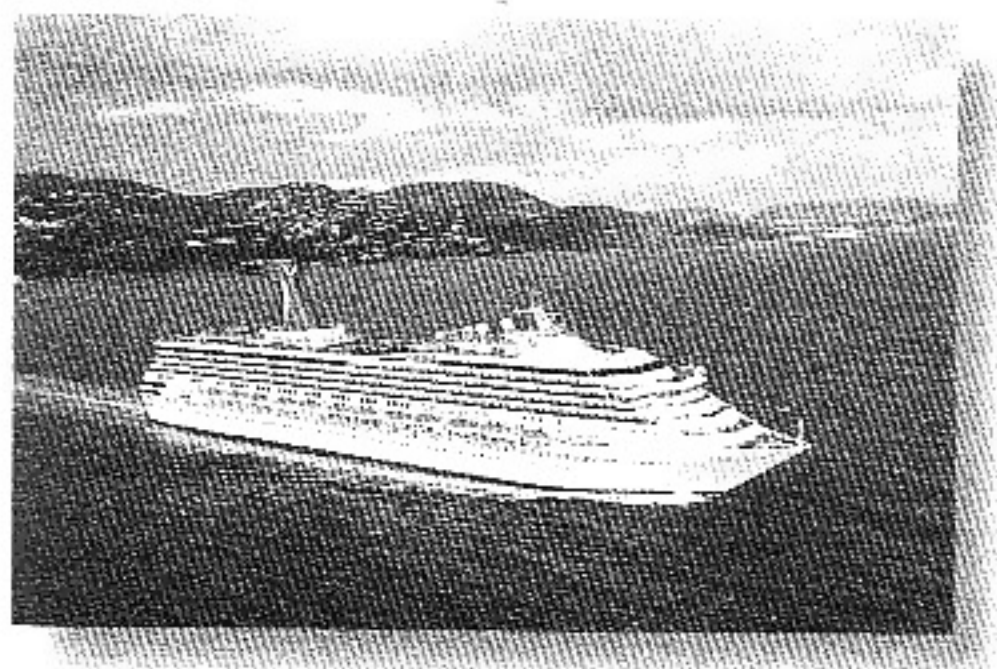


21 TRAVELLING



A man travels the world over in search of what he needs and returns home to find it.

George Moore

Own only what you can carry with you; know language, know countries, know people. Let your memory be your travel bag.

Alexander Solzhenitsyn

□ VOCABULARY INPUT

Dealing with this topic you will come across the following vocabulary. Read it and look up the unknown words in your dictionary.

- **reasons for travelling:** to work, for education, on business, for pleasure, for a holiday, to seek adventure
- **ways of travelling:** with a travel agency, backpacker, globetrotter, budget traveller, self-catering holiday, package tour
- **means of transport:** to travel by car, bus, coach, plane, ship, cruiser, to ride a bike/motorbike, drive a car/bus, fly a plane, go on foot, walk
- **at the airport:** check-in desk, luggage is weighed, air safety rules (sharp and metal objects are detected, passengers are X-rayed/screened), customs, customs officers, gate, boarding card, baggage reclaim
- **kinds of planes:** charter flight, scheduled flight, delayed flight, cancelled flight, postponed flight
 - *plane:* to take off, to land, to crash, to hijack
 - *flight:* charter/scheduled
 - *passengers:* get on/off the plane, board a plane, disembark, catch a plane, miss a plane, fasten seatbelts
 - *on the board:* window seat, middle seat, aisle seat, cockpit
 - departures/arrivals/delays
 - pilot, steward, stewardess, customs officer, police officer
 - jet lag, turbulence
- **trains:** slow, fast, intercity trains, sleeping car, dining car, compartment
- **buses/coaches:** short/long distance, destination, reasonably priced tickets, return ticket/single ticket, to get on/off, to arrive/leave, platform
- **car:** to exceed the speed limit, to get/have a flat tyre, to pay a toll/fine, to get in/out, motorway, crossroads, zebra crossing, roundabout, traffic lights, to overtake, to hitchhike, to run out of petrol, to fill up the tank
- **other means of transport:** ferry, liner, speedboat, submarine, underground, tram, trolleybus, hot air balloon, helicopter, rocket
- **types of holiday:** first minute/last minute holiday, self-catering, backpacking holiday, with a travel agency
- **preparation for journey:** set off on a journey, go on a trip, travel abroad, packing (baggage, luggage, suitcase, carry-ons, map, guide book), arranging (accommodation), confirming the flight, cancelling the flight
 - *documents:* identity card, passport, visa, job permission, insurance, (flight) ticket
- **types of accommodation:** hotel, hostel, motel, B&B (bed and breakfast), chalet, apartment, guesthouse,
- **in the hotel:** luxurious/posh, comfortable
 - to check-in, to check out, to book into a hotel, to make a reservation, wake-up call
 - half board, full board, all-inclusive, continental breakfast, buffet
 - receptionist, porter, holidaymaker, guest
- **travelling in the future:** new destinations (aquatic, cosmic), faster means of transport

□ DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

Before reading the text, discuss the following questions in class.

1. Which place or country would you like to travel to? Why?
2. What means of transport would you use to get there?
3. What experience do you have of travelling with travel agencies?
4. Would you like to travel to exotic destinations as a backpacker? Why/Why not?
5. Have you ever flown? What was it like?
6. Which means of transport is the most dangerous? Why?
7. Which are the most popular destinations for summer and winter holidays for Slovaks?
8. When you go on holiday with your parents, what kind of accommodation do you arrange?
9. What three things do you always pack when you go on holiday?
10. How will people travel in the future and where do you think they will travel to?

□ TEXT

Read the texts below in silence. Check the meaning of the words in bold and answer the questions below.

REASONS FOR TRAVELLING

Every day hundreds of people travel from one place to another for various reasons – to go to work, to go to school, to go somewhere **on business** and **for pleasure**. Travelling abroad has **recently** become very popular. In every season of the year, airports, **railway** stations, **seaports** and bus stops are full of people travelling long or short **distances**. Before 1989, Slovaks **were** basically only **allowed to** travel to Eastern European countries, East Germany, Bulgaria, Romania and the **former** Yugoslavia. Since Slovakia **joined** the EU in 2004, travel has become easier. Nowadays, many Slovak secondary school and university students spend a year or a semester studying abroad. Many Slovak girls work as au pairs mostly in Great Britain and Germany via student agencies which **arrange** everything necessary. Slovaks do not need passports anymore to travel to EU countries; they only need their identity cards. However, there are countries outside the EU which we still need a visa to go to.

1. According to the text, what are common reasons for travelling?
2. Why has entry into the EU made travel easier for Slovaks?

WAYS OF TRAVELLING

The **average** Slovak family tries to **go on holiday** at least once a year. Some prefer winter holiday and go to Slovak or Austrian **ski resorts** to ski. Most people travel during the summer holiday because the weather is usually good then and children do not have to

go to school. Some people prefer to travel to a Slovak holiday resort, but many choose to travel abroad. If families use a travel agency and choose a trip from the agency's brochure, the agency arranges everything for them – travel, **accommodation**, **insurance** and a travel guide. The most frequent summer holiday **destinations** for Slovaks are Croatia, Egypt, Greece, Italy, Spain and Tunisia. Last or first minute offers have recently become extremely popular. However, there are people who prefer to arrange their own holiday without the involvement of a travel agency. They **book** accommodation over the Internet and study everything necessary before their **departure**. They are called **backpackers** and they usually **get to know** the country better because they are in closer contact with its people. There are more and more people for whom travelling is a **lifelong passion**. **Globetrotters** (world travellers) and travel journalists spend most of their time travelling **seeking** adventure and knowledge.

3. What are the most popular destinations for Slovak travellers throughout the year?
4. Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of arranging your holiday with and without the help of travel agencies.

TRAVELLING BY AIR

Travelling by air is exciting, fast, comfortable and relatively safe, but **rather** expensive. In countries, such as the USA, where people have to travel long distances, travelling by air has become quite common. Nowadays, it is **becoming a common practice** in our country to book plane tickets using Internet-based travel agencies. Some **low-cost airlines** sell their tickets only over the Internet. At the airport, passenger show their **flight tickets** and passports. Their luggage is **weighed** and they **go through customs**. For **air traffic safety** both people and luggage have to be **checked** and metal objects have to be **detected**. Some rules even forbid passengers from having **containers filled** with any type of **liquid** in their **hand luggage**. On the plane, a **steward** or **stewardess** shows passengers their seats and gives them safety information. Before the **aircraft** moves, the "*Fasten Your Safety Belts*" and "*No Smoking*" signs are switched on. During the flight passengers are offered meals, **refreshments** and drinks. After **landing**, passengers **disembark** and go to the **arrivals hall**, where they wait for their luggage. After showing their passports and visas to an immigration officer, they are free to go out and enjoy the country in which they have landed.

5. What are low-cost airlines?
6. What happens before departure and after arrival? Use the information from the text.

TRAIN

Trains are cheap, produce less **pollution** and are safe but not very clean and comfortable. This is especially true of slow trains which stop at every station. Fast trains and intercity trains are more comfortable for longer distances. They do not stop at every station. Trains on longer journeys may have a **sleeping car** and a **dining car** to make the journey more pleasant. Speaking about train travel in Europe, we should not forget to mention the *Channel Tunnel*, which connects the British railway system to the continental one. Direct

trains **link** London with other European cities including Paris and Brussels. In the past, train travel was a very popular way of travelling all over the world, but in the last few **decades** it has been replaced by other forms, such as travelling by plane, **coach** and car.

7. What types of trains are mentioned in the text above? What do we know about them?
8. How is the British railway system connected with the continental one?

OTHER MEANS OF TRANSPORT: COACHES, CARS, BIKES

Coaches are buses for long-distance travel. They are fast and comfortable, with **reasonably priced** tickets. In our country, many people prefer coaches to trains. During the **holidays**, travel agencies offer many coach trips to mountain or seaside resorts. Travelling by coach to London, passengers may have the interesting experience of crossing the English Channel by **ferry**.

People's opinions on cars **differ** quite a lot. Some view them positively and some negatively. Cars are comfortable and quick; they are not safe, they **pollute the environment** and are rather expensive. **In spite of that**, the number of cars on our roads and **motorways** grows higher and higher every year. In the USA, there are more cars **per person** than anywhere else (1.9 people per car). Many young drivers **contribute** much to the **accident rate**, which is very high. However, speed limits and strict alcohol tests have **considerably** reduced traffic deaths.

Many people all over the world like travelling by bike. Some go to school by bike, others prefer cycling as a sport or a hobby. Many people go for cycling holiday, which is both healthy and exciting. This type of travel depends much on the weather. Therefore, summer is the best season for cycling tours.

9. What are coaches?
10. How can the accident rate on roads be reduced?

FUTURE FORMS OF TRAVEL

Travel analysts try to **predict** which tourist destinations will be popular in the future and imagine future forms of travel. They say that Slovakia has the potential to become a popular holiday destination **due to** its natural scenery and outdoor sports potential. Therefore, we need to invest a lot of money in our infrastructure and tourist services. They also say that there will be new types of tourist destinations – **aquatic** and cosmic. Flying high above the Earth in an **airship** or staying at an underwater luxury hotel could become a part of our future summer holidays.

11. What needs to be done to make Slovakia a popular holiday destination?
12. What predictions do travel analysts make about future forms of travel and future destinations?

□ VOCABULARY LIST

accommodation – ubytovanie
aircraft – lietadlo
airline – letecká spoločnosť
airship – vzducholod'
aquatic [ə'kwætɪk] – vodný
to arrange – dohodnúť
arrival hall – priletová hala
average – priemer, priemerný
backpacker – individuálny turista, ktorý si sám organizuje cestu
to book – zarezervovať si
to check – skontrolovať
coach – diaľkový autobus
container – nádoba
to contribute – prispievať
considerably – výrazne
decade – dekáda
departure [dɪ'pɑ:tʃə(r)] – odchod
destination – miesto dovolenky
to detect – zistiť
to differ – líšiť sa
dining car – jedáľenský vozeň
to disembark – vystúpiť
distance – vzdialenosť
due to [dju:tə] – kvôli
to fasten – pripútať sa
ferry [ferɪ] – trajekt
to fill – naplniť
flight ticket – letenka
former – bývalý
globetrotter – svetobežník
hand luggage – príručná batožina
holiday (AmE: vacation) – dovolenka
holidays – prázdniny
in spite of (that) – napriek tomu
insurance [ɪn'ʃʊərəns] – poistenie
to join [dʒɔɪn] – pripojiť sa
to land – pristáť

lifelong passion [pæfɪn] – celoživotná vášeň
link – spoj
liquid [lɪkwɪd] – tekutina
low-cost – nízkonákladový
motorway – diaľnica
per person – na osobu
pollution [pə'lu:ʃn] – znečistenie
to predict – predpovedať
rather – dosť, príliš
railway – železnica
recently [ri:sntli] – nedávno
refreshment – občerstvenie
seaport – prímorský prístav
to seek [si:k] – hľadať
ski resort – lyžiarske stredisko
sleeping car – spací vozeň
steward – palubný sprievodca
stewardess – letuška
to weigh – vážiť, odvážiť

accident rate – nehodovosť
air traffic safety – bezpečnosť leteckej prevádzky
to be allowed to do – mať dovolené urobiť
to become a common practice – stať sa bežnou praxou
for pleasure [pleʒə(r)] – pre potešenie
to get to know – spoznávať
to go on holiday – ísť na dovolenku
to go through customs – prejsť colnou kontrolou
on business – služobne
to pollute the environment – znečisťovať životné prostredie
reasonably priced – cenovo výhodný

□ VOCABULARY PRACTICE

Task 1 Which means of transport might you see in the following places?

Example: in the air: plane, jet, hot air balloon, helicopter (chopper)...

a) at a seaport: _____

b) on a highway: _____

c) under the water: _____

d) in the streets: _____

e) on the railways: _____

f) in the mountains: _____

Task 2 Preparation for a journey. Make a list of FIVE objects you would definitely pack in your backpack if you were planning on going to an exotic country as a backpacker. Write them down in order of their importance. Compare your list with your partner and explain the reasons of your choices.

Example: passport

5. _____

4. _____



1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

Task 3 Which instructions would you certainly follow if you were travelling to the following destinations for the following reasons:

- The High Tatras – a self-catering skiing holiday with your family
- Thailand – as a backpacker with your best friend
- Paris – as a tourist with a travel agency going sightseeing

- | | |
|--|---|
| a) check the validity of your passport | i) pack some medicine |
| b) print the route of your journey | j) confirm your flight ticket |
| c) arrange accommodation on your own over the Internet | k) ask about visa requirements |
| d) read hotel reviews | l) choose the sights you want to see |
| e) change money | m) find out about the local culture/food/customs/safety |
| f) arrange travel insurance | n) learn phrases in the local language |
| g) pack waterproof clothes | o) pack a pair of hiking boots |
| h) take medication against malaria | |

Task 4 Read the following list of rules which passengers have to follow when they travel by air. Are they TRUE? FALSE? IFFY? Correct the false ones. If you are not sure, check on the Internet.

- a) Passengers can take their own drink on board.
- b) If passengers' luggage is overweight, they have to pay an extra fee for it.
- c) Passengers have to take off their shoes when they walk through metal detectors.
- d) Passengers are allowed to smoke in the toilets in a plane.
- e) Passengers can buy duty-free goods on board directly from the stewards/stewardesses.
- f) Passengers can use their laptops and mobiles on board.
- g) Passengers are recommended to keep their seatbelt fastened during the whole flight.
- h) Passengers receive a boarding pass after they hand over their luggage at the check-in desk.
- i) Passengers are expected to arrive at the airport at least 30 minutes prior to the flight's departure.
- j) If scissors or any other sharp objects are detected before boarding on the plane, they are taken away from the passenger.
- k) Babies on board can be seated in the lap of the adult person accompanying the baby.

□ REVIEW

Task 11 What is the difference in meaning between the following words? If you are not sure, check their meanings in your dictionary.

- | | |
|---|---|
| a) ship/boat/yacht/ferry | g) road/route/way |
| b) bus/coach | h) double room/twin room/single room/en-suite |
| c) van/sleeping car/compartment | i) lobby/foyer/hall |
| d) check-in/check out | j) vehicle/vessel |
| e) to land/to take off | k) platform/gate |
| f) journey/voyage/cruise/trip/excursion | l) to get in/to get on |

Task 12 In groups, design a vehicle that could be used in the future for travelling. Draw it and describe it to your class. Consider its size, the material it will be made of, how it will be steered, the type of energy it will use, the kind of people who might use it, destinations and its impact upon the environment. Let your classmates decide whether they would use your invented vehicle for travelling or not.